PUBLICATION

The Economics of AI Scribes: ROI Analysis for Healthcare Organizations

Hard numbers on cost savings, productivity gains, reimbursement improvements, and reduced coding errors when deploying AI documentation at scale.

Published:	July 2025
Document ID:	PUB-2025-007
Classification:	Public
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1. Executive Summary

Healthcare organisations considering AI documentation adoption need to justify the investment with concrete financial analysis. This publication provides a framework for calculating the return on investment (ROI) of deploying ClinixSummary, based on real-world deployment data and published research on documentation costs.

2. The Cost of Manual Documentation

Before calculating ROI, organisations must understand the true cost of their current documentation burden:

- Direct time cost — Average clinician spends 2 hours/day on documentation. At median physician compensation of $150/hour, this represents $78,000/year per physician in documentation labour.
- Opportunity cost — Those 2 hours could be spent seeing 4–6 additional patients, generating $200–$600 in additional revenue per day.
- Overtime and burnout costs — After-hours documentation drives overtime costs and contributes to turnover ($500K–$1M per physician departure).
- Coding errors — Manual documentation produces coding errors in 20–30% of encounters, resulting in claim denials, downcoding, and revenue leakage.

3. ROI Components

3.1 Time Savings

ClinixSummary reduces per-encounter documentation time by an average of 81%. For a practice with 10 clinicians each seeing 20 patients per day, this translates to:

- Total documentation time saved: 26 hours per day across the practice.
- Annualised time savings: 6,760 hours per year (based on 260 working days).
- Labour cost savings: $507,000–$1,014,000 per year (depending on clinician compensation).

3.2 Increased Patient Throughput

With documentation time reduced, clinicians can see additional patients. Conservative estimates of 2 additional patients per clinician per day yield:

- Additional encounters: 5,200 per year (10 clinicians × 2 patients × 260 days).
- Additional revenue: $520,000–$1,560,000 per year (at $100–$300 per encounter).

3.3 Improved Coding Accuracy

AI-generated documentation captures clinical detail more consistently, supporting appropriate coding. Organisations deploying ClinixSummary report a 15–25% reduction in claim denials and a measurable improvement in coding specificity.

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3.4 Reduced Turnover

By addressing the #1 driver of clinician burnout, AI documentation reduces turnover risk. Even preventing one physician departure per year saves $500K–$1M in recruitment, onboarding, and lost revenue.

4. Total ROI Summary

For a representative 10-clinician practice:

- Annual ClinixSummary cost: approximately $36,000–$60,000 (depending on plan).
- Conservative annual benefit: $700,000–$2,000,000.
- ROI: 12–33x investment.
- Payback period: less than 30 days.

5. Beyond the Numbers

Some benefits resist quantification but are equally important: clinician wellbeing, patient satisfaction from more present clinicians, reduced medico-legal risk from complete documentation, and improved care quality from better clinical data capture.

6. Conclusion

The ROI of AI documentation is compelling by any measure. The financial case alone — time savings, throughput gains, coding accuracy, and retention — justifies adoption. The human case — restored clinical joy, better patient relationships, reduced burnout — makes it imperative.

For a customised ROI analysis for your organisation, visit the ROI Calculator at clinixsummary.ai or contact: sales@clinixsummary.ai

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